

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/12: HOW TO READ A PAINTING

READING CHAIN

support / surface

- > technique / pigment
- > patron / workshop
- > audience / function
- > theme / iconography
- > stylistic comparison
- > evidence limit

RULE

Style is not the starting point.

A wall, folio, album page and ritual cloth belong to different visual worlds.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/12: VOCABULARY AND TECHNIQUE

SHADANGA

Roopbheda / Pramana / Bhava / Lavanya Yojana / Sadrishya / Varnikabhanga

FORMAT TERMS

mural = fixed architectural surface

miniature = small portable format

album = curated folio for private viewing

TECHNIQUE CAUTION

Ajanta is safer as fresco secco / tempera on prepared dry plaster,
not as an unqualified true fresco.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/12: PREHISTORIC BASELINE

ROCK ART

Bhimbetka

Lakhudiyar

-> hunting / dancing / animals / group scenes

-> mineral colours on rock surface

LIMIT

Useful for environment and community memory.

Not enough for named dynasties or rigid doctrinal claims.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/12: AJANTA DOSSIER

AJANTA

early phase + Vakataka flowering

- > Buddhist caves
- > Jataka and Buddha narratives
- > Bodhisattvas such as Padmapani
- > courtly detail and emotional modelling

TRAP

Ajanta is not a single-phase event.

Technique caution must remain explicit.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/12: BAGH AND HALLISALASYA

BAGH

Dhar district, on the Baghni river

- > Gupta-era mural anchor
- > stronger outlines, more earthly human register
- > Cave 4 = Rang Mahal

HALLISALASYA RULE

Keep only the source-safe line:

royal courts + temples + ceremonial gatherings;

Gupta-period devotional or courtly dance in art and sculpture.

Do not assign a modern named classical form.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/12: SOUTH INDIAN MURAL LINE

Sittanavasal

- > Pallava site bank: Kanchipuram / Panamalai / Mamandur
- > Armamalai bridge
- > Brihadisvara mural memory
- > Lepakshi continuation

FINAL RULE

Survival gaps, repainting and damage distort what remains.
Few murals today do not prove weak original production.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/12: EARLY PORTABLE PAINTING

Pala School

- > Buddhist illustrated manuscripts
- > palm leaf / compact compositions / subdued grounds

Western Indian / Apabhramsa

- > Jain-dominant manuscripts
- > red / yellow / ochre
- > angular face / fish-shaped eye / strong contour
- > Kalpasutra / Kalakacharya Katha

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/12: SULTANATE TO MUGHAL FORMATION

TRANSITION

Persianate contact + indigenous manuscript habits

-> Nimatnama at Mandu

MUGHAL FORMATION

Humayun -> Mir Sayyid Ali + Abdus Samad

Akbar -> Tasvir Khana -> Tutinama / Hamzanama / Razmnama / Akbarnama

RULE

Synthesis precedes Mughal maturity.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/12: JAHANGIR AND AFTER

AKBAR

large collaborative illustrated manuscripts

JAHANGIR

album page / individual portrait / flora-fauna / allegory

Ustad Mansur / Abu'l Hasan

SHAH JAHAN -> court polish

AURANGZEB -> reduced patronage -> artist dispersal

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/12: REGIONAL MINIATURE FAMILIES

DECCANI

saturated colour / elongated figures / fantastic landscape

RAJASTHANI

Mewar / Bundi / Kota / Jaipur / Kishangarh

Bani Thani -> Kishangarh

PAHARI

Basohli -> Guler -> Kangra

RULE

Shared Persianate resources do not erase regional distinction.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/12: DEVOTIONAL, COLONIAL AND MODERN TURNS

DEVOTIONAL OBJECT SURFACES

Tanjore -> gold-rich central devotional image

Mysore -> fine line + gesso

Ganjifa -> painted cards

COLONIAL / MODERN

Company -> hybrid patronage

Kalighat -> urban market sheet

Ravi Varma -> oil + print public

Bengal School -> Bharat Mata / wash response

Santiniketan -> experimentation

Progressive Artists Group -> post-1947 modernism

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/12: FOLK / TRIBAL CONTINUITY AND FINAL FORMULA

FOLK / TRIBAL BANK

Madhubani -> Mithila / ritual / bold colour

Pattachitra -> Odisha / treated cloth / Jagannath world

Kalamkari -> treated cloth / pen-block process

Warli -> white on ochre / geometric wall language

Gond -> patterned sacred-natural world

Phad / Cheriyal -> long scroll + performance

FINAL FORMULA

Indian painting shows continuity through adaptation of support, technique, patronage and audience - from rock shelter to mural, manuscript, album, market sheet and living ritual wall.